

LFX Linux Kernel Mentorship Blog

From Embedded Linux to Kernel Contributor: My Linux Kernel Mentorship Journey

LFX Linux Kernel Mentorship — Spring 2026

Primary subsystem: Industrial I/O (IIO)

Blog: <https://sanjay-embedded.github.io/LFX-Linux-kernel-Spring-2026/>

This blog captures my transition from an Embedded Linux, BSP and product-development background to deeper participation in the **upstream Linux kernel community** through the IIO subsystem.

Journey

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Embedded Linux / BSP / Product Development
      ↓
    LFX Linux Kernel Mentorship
      ↓
Independent Linux Kernel Contributor
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The mentorship focused on driver modernization and preventive maintenance, resource ownership and lifecycle, review-driven patch development, and the upstream workflow from mailing-list submission through linux-next and mainline.

During the mentorship, **20 contributions reached mainline Linux**, with **27 additional changes progressing through linux-next**.

A key lesson was that a good upstream patch is not only about fixing code; it must also be easy to review, maintain, integrate and bisect. My most memorable review guidance was:

| **“The rule of thumb is one logical change per patch.”**

The full technical evidence and contribution history are maintained in this repository. A reusable guide for future contributors is also available:

Kernel Upstream Contribution Guide: <https://github.com/sanjay-embedded/oss-guide/blob/master/kernel-upstream.rst>